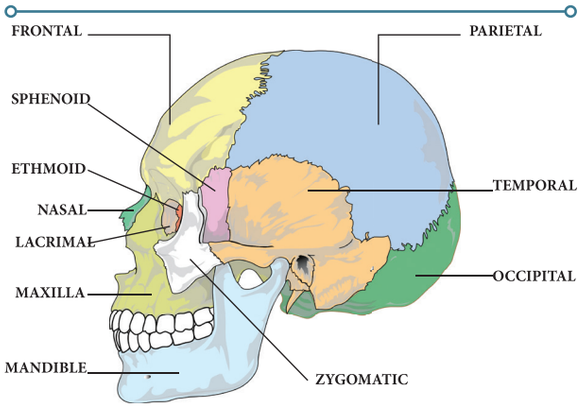


DO YOU KNOW? The only movable joint in the skull is lower mandible.

Two nasal bones – which form the bridge of the nose.

Two lacrimal bones -near the eyes it is very thin and small.

Two cheek bones.

Two upper jaw bones.

Two palate bones – which join with the upper jaw bones in forming the hard palate.

Mandible bone – It is horse shoe shaped are forms the lower jaw.

Two curled bone, one in each side of wall of the nose.

Vomer bone – which rests on the palate and helps to form the nasal septum.

SKULL BONE

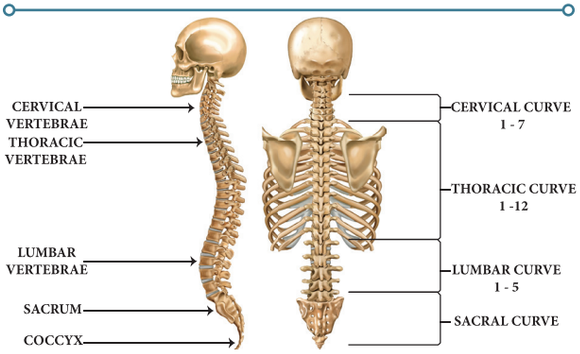
2.3.3 Vertebral Column

Spine or backbone is the central part of the skeleton. It supports the head and encloses the spinal cord. It consists of 33 irregular bones called "vertebrae".

DO YOU KNOW? Human beings are the only living things which sleep on their back.

PARTS OF THE VERTEBRAL COLUMN ARE AS FOLLOWS

- Cervical vertebrae is in the neck region. The first two bones called atlas and axis which are important for nodding and turning the head.
- 12 dorsal or thoracic vertebrae at the back of the chest. The ribs are joined to these vertebrae.
- 5 lumbar vertebrae are in the waist region.
- 5 sacral vertebrae are fused together to form the sacrum. It is a triangular shaped bone with a hollow anteriorly. The sacrum helps to form the pelvis.
- 4 small vertebrae in the tail region are fused to form a small triangular bone called as coccyx (tailbone).



FUNCTIONS OF THE VERTEBRAL COLUMN

- Movement of the body.
- Support the head and the organs of the thorax and abdomen.
- Protection for the spinal cord.
- Balance the erect position.

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